



Introduction

The Carbon class is inherited (<http://php.net/manual/en/keyword.extends.php>) from the PHP DateTime (<http://www.php.net/manual/en/class.datetime.php>) class.

```
<?php
namespace Carbon;

class Carbon extends \DateTime
{
    // code here
}
```

You can see from the code snippet above that the Carbon class is declared in the Carbon namespace. You need to import the namespace to use Carbon without having to provide its fully qualified name each time.

```
use Carbon\Carbon;
```

Examples in this documentation will assume you imported classes of the Carbon namespace this way.

If you're using Laravel, you may check our [Laravel configuration and best-practices recommendations \(/laravel\)](#).

If you're using Symfony, you may check our [Symfony configuration and best-practices recommendations \(/symfony\)](#).

We also provide CarbonImmutable class extending DateTimeImmutable (<http://www.php.net/manual/en/class.datetimeimmutable.php>). The same methods are available on both classes but when you use a modifier on a Carbon instance, it modifies and returns the same instance, when you use it on CarbonImmutable, it returns a new instances with the new value.



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carbon

lib.here

hide

output